Norwegian University of
Science and Technology

Formally Verified Reduction Proof for the Half-Gates Garbling Scheme

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Problem description

Garbled circuits are a fundamental cryptographic primitive used in secure two-party computation (2PC), enabling two parties to jointly compute a function without revealing their private inputs—only the output is revealed. The concept was introduced by Andrew Yao in 1986 [Yao86], where functions are expressed as Boolean circuits and each wire is labelled with encrypted wire keys. Early constructions required four ciphertexts per gate, resulting in significant communication overhead and limiting practical adoption.

Subsequent optimizations such as Point-and-Permute and the Half-Gates technique greatly reduced the number of ciphertexts needed per gate, leading to substantial performance improvements [BMR90; ZRE15]. These optimizations form the basis of many state-of-the-art secure computation frameworks.

Formal verification of cryptographic constructions is essential to ensure correctness and prevent subtle vulnerabilities arising from unchecked corner cases. Brzuska and Oechsner [BO23] developed a state-separating pen-and-paper reduction proof for Yao's original garbling scheme. State-separating proofs model protocol components as isolated "packages" with private state and oracle interfaces, allowing for structured security reductions. Their work established security by reducing the garbling scheme to the IND-CPA security of the encryption primitive used for gate tables.

Domino is an automated verification tool specifically designed for state-separating proofs. It has been used to reason about complex real-world protocols such as TLS [Raj25] and WPA2 [BDE+22]. Domino offers a high level of automation and readability because proof scripts resemble the pseudocode found in traditional cryptographic proofs.

Furthermore, the above mentioned proof for Yao's garbling scheme by Brzuska and Oechsner [BO23] was later formalized in Domino [BW]. It can serve as a good starting point for the thesis to observe how games may be converted from pen and paper proofs to Domino code.

The goal of this thesis is to formalize and mechanize a security reduction for the Half-Gates garbling scheme within the Domino framework. This includes:

- Developing a state-separating, pen-and-paper reduction proof for the Half-Gates technique.
- Encoding this proof in Domino.

This work extends formal verification techniques to an optimized and widely deployed garbling construction and demonstrates Domino's applicability to modern cryptographic primitives.

Approved: yyyy-mm-dd – Tjerand Silde, NTNU (Main supervisor)

Abstract

Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. If you read this text, you will get no information. Really? Is there no information? Is there a difference between this text and some nonsense like “Huardest gefburn”? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language.

This is the second paragraph. Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. If you read this text, you will get no information. Really? Is there no information? Is there a difference between this text and some nonsense like “Huardest gefburn”? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language.

And after the second paragraph follows the third paragraph. Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. If you read this text, you will get no information. Really? Is there no information? Is there a difference between this text and some nonsense like “Huardest gefburn”? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language.

After this fourth paragraph, we start a new paragraph sequence. Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. If you read this text, you will get no information. Really? Is there no information? Is there a difference between this text and some nonsense like “Huardest gefburn”? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of

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Preface

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Example

Here is an example of how to use acronyms such as Norwegian University of Science and Technology (NTNU). The second time only NTNU is shown and if there were several you would write NTNUs. And here is an example[1] of citation [NNNN21].

This is the second paragraph. Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. If you read this text, you will get no information. Really? Is there no information? Is there a difference between this text and some nonsense like “Huardest gefburn”? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language.

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[1] A footnote

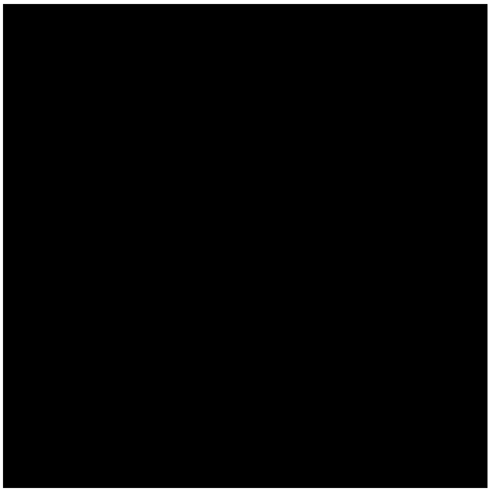

Figure 1.1: A figure

This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language.

1.1 First section (verbose version)

1.1.1 First subsection with some $\mathcal{M}ath$ symbol

Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. If you read this text, you will get no information. Really? Is there no information? Is there a difference between this text and some nonsense like "Huardest gefburn"? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language.

- item1
- item2
- ...

1.1.2 Mathematics

Hello, here is some text without a meaning. This text should show what a printed text will look like at this place. $\sin^2(\alpha) + \cos^2(\beta) = 1$. If you read this text, you will get no information $E = mc^2$. Really? Is there no information? Is there a

Table 1.1: A table

a	b	c	d	e
f	g	h	i	j
k	l	m	n	o
p	q	r	s	t
u	v	w	x	y
z	æ	ø	å	

difference between this text and some nonsense like "Huardest gefburn"? Kjift – not at all! A blind text like this gives you information about the selected font, how the letters are written and an impression of the look. $\sqrt[n]{a} \cdot \sqrt[n]{b} = \sqrt[n]{ab}$. This text should contain all letters of the alphabet and it should be written in of the original language. $\frac{\sqrt[n]{a}}{\sqrt[n]{b}} = \sqrt[n]{\frac{a}{b}}$. There is no need for special content, but the length of words should match the language. $a\sqrt[n]{b} = \sqrt[n]{a^n b}$.

Proposition 1.1. *A proposition... (similar environments include: theorem, corollary, conjecture, lemma)*

Proof. And its proof. ☐

1.1.3 Source code example

Algorithm 1.1 The Hello World! program in Java.

```
class HelloWorldApp {
  public static void main(String[] args) {
    //Display the string
    System.out.println("Hello World!");
  }
}
```

You can refer to figures using the predefined command like Figure 1.1, to pages like Page 1.1, to tables like Table 1.1, to chapters like Chapter 1 and to sections like Section 1.1 and you may define similar commands to refer to proposition, algorithms etc.

Chapter 2
Introduction

Chapter 3
Background

Chapter 4

Pen-and-Paper State-Separating Proof

Chapter 5
Domino

Chapter 6
Conclusion

References

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